❷ Initializes the list items in the constructor

❸ Creates a single instance of each group to pass to SelectListItems

❹ Sets the appropriate group for each SelectListItem

❺ If a SelectListItem doesn't have a Group, it won't be added to an <optgroup>.

With this in place, the Select Tag Helper generates `<optgroup>` elements as necessary when rendering the Razor to HTML. The Razor template

```
@page
@model SelectListsModel
<select asp-for="SelectedValues" asp-items="Model.Items"></select>
```

would be rendered to HTML as follows:

```
<select id="SelectedValues" name="SelectedValues" multiple="multiple">
    <optgroup label="Dynamic">
        <option value="js">JavaScript</option>
        <option value="python">Python</option>
    </optgroup>
    <optgroup label="Static">
        <option value="cpp">C++</option>
    </optgroup>
    <option value="csharp">C#</option>
</select>
```

Another common requirement when working with `<select>` elements is to include an option in the list that indicates that no value has been selected, as shown in figure 18.7. Without this extra option, the default `<select>` drop-down will always have a value, and it will default to the first item in the list.